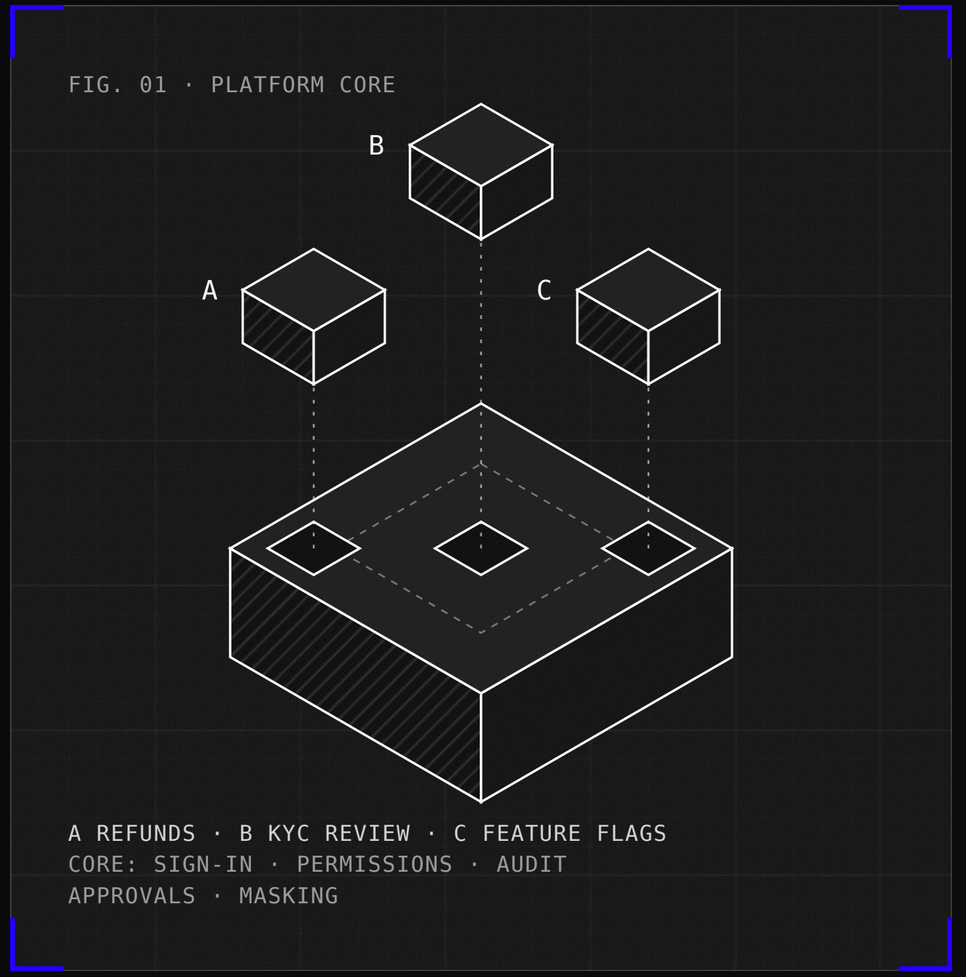
Power Apps or build with Devin?

Build with Devin in phases, refunds dashboard first



Thomas Pritchard · Prepared for the VP of Engineering · October 2026

Power Apps secures the platform, not each app's own controls

- Today: $250K a year, approx. 1,000 users at $20 a month each (our estimate)
- 2027: approx. $275K; the 10+ new tools add no licence cost
- Real value: the bottom two layers, and ops editing their own apps

What the licence covers

Build: canvas and model-driven apps

Logic: Power Fx and Power Automate

Connectors: 1,000+, Teams and Outlook

> Data: Dataverse, row security, audit

> Governance: Entra, data loss rules, SOC 2 and ISO

Left to each app to build

Blocking self-approval

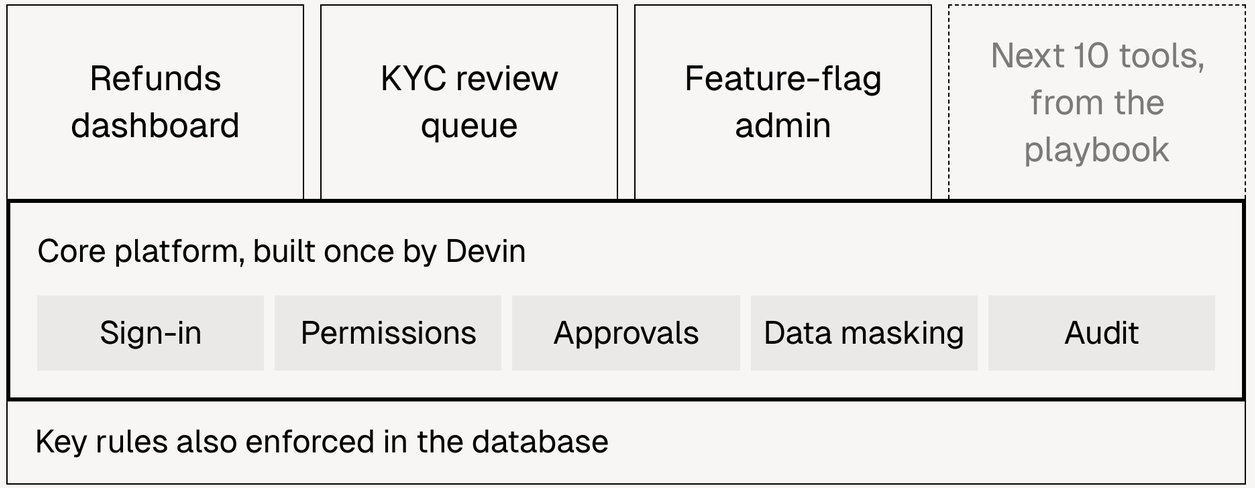
Hiding customer data

An exportable audit trail

Source: Microsoft pricing and Microsoft Learn; licensing advisors on the 2027 price rise; see A1 and A2

One core platform, lightweight tools on top

- Refunds first, with an engineer steering; Devin then wrote the playbook
- KYC queue and flag admin from the playbook: one Devin session each, under $10 each
- A separate Devin session attacked the build: 4 holes found, all fixed before merge
- Every change is a pull request, gated by tests, Devin Review and code owners



Source: this repo, docs/DEVIN-LOG.md and docs/SECURITY-REVIEW.md; see A3

Three tools.

One core platform.

Most of it is replicable with Devin; the risk is owning it

Replicable with Devin	Hard to replicate	Where the risk is
Screens, queues and forms	Microsoft's SOC 2 and ISO scope	You own on-call, upgrades and security
Approvals, masking and audit	Ops editing apps without engineers	AI-written code needs tests and review
Tests and Git history	1,000+ connectors, Teams, Outlook	Moving data and retraining users

Source: Microsoft Learn; our build and security review; see A2 and A3

Building runs approx. $85K to $190K a year, vs $275K for Power Apps

- One-off cost to move: approx. $75K to $200K
- Then saves approx. $85K to $190K a year; pays back in 1 to 2.5 years
- Devin: approx. $100 built all three prototypes

Yearly, once running	Estimate
Half to one engineer owning it	$70K to $140K
Hosting, monitoring, pen test	$10K to $28K
Devin seats and usage	$6K to $22K
Total per year	approx. $85K to $190K
Power Apps, 2027 price	approx. $275K

Source: Microsoft pricing; Devin billing docs; Devin usage, 16 Oct; every build number an estimate; see A4

Build in phases: refunds dashboard first, new tools from the playbook

Weeks 1 to 2

Discovery with your team: apps, connectors, compliance, seats

Gate: savings known

Devin: documents your current apps

Weeks 3 to 12

Refunds to production, alongside the Power App

Gate: results match, ops sign off

Devin: builds and tests from the playbook

Months 3 to 6

Switch refunds; next tools from the playbook

Gate: each tool on budget

Devin: one session per tool, in parallel

After 6 months

KYC after compliance sign-off; buy a flag product

Gate: auditor sign-off

Devin: scheduled upkeep and security reviews

Stop at any gate if it needs more than one engineer. Staying on Power Apps? Devin still writes tests and migrations. Next step: a working session on your stack.

Source: our build and assessment; see A4 for costs and gaps

Appendix

Reference for after the call: A1 Licensing · A2 Controls · A3 Build evidence · A4 Cost detail · A5 Sources

A1 · Licensing

Premium	$20 per user per month with unlimited apps. The $12 tier needs 2,000 seats, so it doesn't apply
Seats	$250,000 / $240 = 1,042 implied seats at list price. Same seats in 2027 at $22: $275,088
Price rise	To $22 from 1 Jan 2027, notice MC1470566. Reported by four licensing advisors; Message Center only
Per app	On the same seats: $83K per app at 3 apps, $19K at 13. Each extra app costs $0
Pay-as-you-go	$10 per active user per app per month (licensing advisors; not on Microsoft's public page). Saves $144 a year for one-app users at 2027 prices
Enforcement	From Feb 2027, in managed environments only. Every user who runs an app needs a licence; Premium, per-app passes, pay-as-you-go and trials all count
Admin check	The "Users requiring licenses in Managed Environments" report. Seats can only be reduced at renewal

Source: Microsoft pricing and Microsoft Learn; licensing advisors on notice MC1470566; see A5

A2 · Controls, Power Apps vs our build

	Power Apps	Our build	Our remaining gaps
Self-approval	Not documented as built in; the requester field is optional free text	Blocked in code and by a database rule	None known
Masking	Column security, but data is never hidden from system administrators	Masked on the server; reveal needs a reason, 20 per user per hour, audited	Database owner sees raw rows
Audit	History kept; exporting audit logs isn't supported	Append-only, written in the same transaction; denials and reveals audited; CSV export	No tamper-evident hash chain
Identity	Entra, Conditional Access, Managed Environments	Standard sign-in, with Keycloak standing in for Entra	Role removal applies at next sign-in
Scale	Some queries read only 500 rows and return incorrect results	SQL over Postgres	None known
Change control	Test Engine deprecated; canvas Git removed	Code owners, required CI, tests written before code	Merge queue off
Retention	Retention policies	KYC cases kept 5 years by a database rule (UK MLR 2017 reg 40)	Auditor acceptance untested

Source: Microsoft Learn; docs/SECURITY-REVIEW.md; see A5

A3 · Build evidence

	Refunds dashboard	KYC review queue	Feature-flag admin
Business logic	585 lines	566 lines	542 lines
How it was built	Engineer steering Devin	GitHub issue and playbook, one session	GitHub issue and playbook, one session
Devin cost	$23.94	$7.30	$8.26
Tests written to fail first	30 of 34	Not logged	52 of 62
Attacks that worked, all fixed	Bulk unmasking, splitting a refund, unlogged denials	None	Unlogged service denials

Whole build: 401 tests plus 8 end-to-end, all passing; every pull request opened by Devin. Devin spend $132.27 in total, including $33.87 for the shared platform, $9.85 security review, $8.75 UX polish, $14.10 fixes and $21.62 on this deck and docs. My own review time, not logged, is estimated at 8 to 12 hours.

Source: this repo, GitHub PRs, CI on main; Devin usage page, 16 Oct; see A5

A4 · Cost detail and what production needs

Item	Estimate	Basis
Engineer owning it, yearly	$70K to $140K	0.5 to 1 engineer at $140K loaded London cost
Hosting and monitoring, yearly	$5K to $16K	Small cloud setup with backups, firewall and alerts
Pen test, yearly	$5K to $12K	£3.5K to £6.5K per test, plus fixes and retest
Devin, yearly	$6K to $22K	5 Teams seats at $40 a month; builds; nightly maintenance runs capped at $40 a night
Integrations, once	$18K to $36K	Entra, payment provider, document storage: 6 to 12 engineer-weeks
Data migration, once	$15K to $50K	Moving records and history off Dataverse
Testing with ops and cutover, once	$30K to $75K	Running alongside the Power App, then 2 to 6 weeks of support
Training, once	$10K to $40K	Only users of tools that move
Not counted	Today's Power Apps admin and maker time	Ask the client; it narrows the gap further

Source: cloud and pen-test pricing from vendors and advisors; Devin billing docs; every number an estimate; see A5

A5 · Sources

1 Power Apps pricing (Microsoft)
microsoft.com/power-platform/products/power-apps/pricing

2 Managed environment licensing (Microsoft Learn)
learn.microsoft.com/power-platform/admin/managed-environment-licensing

3 Managed environments overview (Microsoft Learn)
learn.microsoft.com/power-platform/admin/managed-environment-overview

4 Approvals connector (Microsoft Learn)
learn.microsoft.com/connectors/approvals

5 Dataverse security and column security (Microsoft Learn)
learn.microsoft.com/power-platform/admin/wp-security-cds

6 Auditing (Microsoft Learn)
learn.microsoft.com/power-platform/admin/audit-data-user-activity

7 Data loss prevention (Microsoft Learn)
learn.microsoft.com/power-platform/admin/wp-data-loss-prevention

8 Delegation, 500-row limit (Microsoft Learn)
learn.microsoft.com/power-apps/maker/canvas-apps/delegation-overview

9 Test Engine and Git integration (Microsoft Learn)
learn.microsoft.com/power-platform/test-engine/overview

10 SOC 2 offering (Microsoft Learn)
learn.microsoft.com/compliance/regulatory/offering-soc-2

11 2027 price rise and enforcement (SAMexpert, third party)
samexpert.com/power-apps-2027-enforcement-price-increase

12 Per-app plan and pay-as-you-go (SAMexpert, third party)
samexpert.com/power-apps-per-app-plan-retired

13 2027 price rise (2Data, third party)
2-data.com/knowledge-hub (Power Apps Premium price rise)

14 Devin billing and enterprise security (Cognition)
docs.devin.ai/admin/billing

15 UK MLR 2017, regulation 40 (legislation.gov.uk)
legislation.gov.uk/uksi/2017/692/regulation/40

16 This build: repo, CI and Devin usage page (measured)
github.com/tompritch30/fintech-internal-tools; docs/research, docs/submission/EVIDENCE.md, docs/SECURITY-REVIEW.md